Advanced Punctuation

Year 4 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked example: Punctuate: "Watch out shouted Leo the ball is coming"

Answer: "Watch out!" shouted Leo. "The ball is coming!"

Easy / Standard (15 questions)

1. Add speech marks: "Good morning said Mrs Patel."
2. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "I'm ready!" he shouted. B) I'm ready! he shouted. C) "I'm ready" he shouted! D) "I'm ready," he shouted!
3. Add a colon: "She owned two pets a cat and a dog."
4. Add speech marks: "Thank you replied Jess."
5. Which mark correctly completes: He needed one thing ___ courage. A) , B) ; C) : D) !
6. Add speech marks: "That hurts cried Ben."
7. Join with a semicolon: "It was late. We went home."
8. Select ALL the sentences that correctly punctuate a warning shouted aloud: A) "Look out!" warned the lifeguard. B) Look out! warned the lifeguard. C) "Be careful!" warned Dad. D) Be careful warned Dad. E) "Watch out!" warned the guide.
9. Add a colon: "There was one rule no shouting."
10. Add speech marks: "I found it shouted Ali."
11. Which mark correctly joins these two closely related sentences? The fire crackled ___ we felt warm. A) , B) ; C) : D) !
12. Add speech marks: "Can I help asked the shopkeeper."
13. Which correctly completes: She packed one item ___ her passport. A) , B) ; C) : D) ?
14. Add speech marks: "Well played said the coach."
15. Join with a semicolon: "The lights dimmed. The film began."

Standard (15 questions)

1. Punctuate: "Can we go now asked Ellie I'm bored."
2. Which correctly completes: He had one aim ___ to finish first. A) , B) : C) ; D) !
3. Join with a semicolon: "The play was long. The audience stayed until the end."
4. Punctuate: "Help me shouted the swimmer."
5. Rewrite with correct new lines for speech: "Hi said Omar Hello replied Zara."
6. Add a colon: "The list had three names Sam Priya and Leo."
7. Which mark correctly joins: The garden was quiet ___ only the birds could be heard. A) , B) ; C) : D) -
8. Punctuate: "I can't find my shoes moaned Jack."

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9. Select ALL the sentences that correctly use a colon to introduce an explanation: A) The match was postponed: one reason the pitch was flooded. B) The match was postponed, one reason the pitch was flooded. C) The coach gave one warning: no more fouls. D) The coach gave one warning, no more fouls. E) He had one aim: to finish first.

10. Punctuate: "Mind the gap announced the guard."

11. Join with a semicolon: "The cake rose perfectly. Everyone was impressed."

12. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "Is this yours?" he asked, holding up the scarf. B) Is this yours? he asked, holding up the scarf. C) "Is this yours" he asked, holding up the scarf? D) "Is this yours," he asked, holding up the scarf?

13. Add a colon: "The coach gave one warning no more fouls."

14. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "We won!" she cheered. B) We won! she cheered. C) "We won" she cheered! D) "We won," she cheered!

15. Join with a semicolon: "The train was delayed. Passengers waited patiently."

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Which punctuation mark most precisely links these two sentences, and why? "The sky darkened ___ a storm was clearly coming."

2. Which punctuation mark is needed here, and why? "She had only one fear ___ spiders."

3. What is wrong with the capitalisation here, and how should it be corrected: "He whispered, "be quiet""?

4. Is this a comma splice, and if so, how should it be fixed? "The rain stopped, the sun came out."

5. In "I'll be there at 7:30," is the colon used the same way as a colon before a list, and why or why not?

6. Punctuate this short exchange between two speakers, using a new line for each: "Where have you been asked Mum I was at the library replied Sam."

7. Read: "The recipe was simple flour eggs milk and a pinch of salt." Add a colon and the missing commas.

8. Punctuate this sentence, which needs a colon for a list and a semicolon to join two related ideas: "She packed everything she needed a tent a torch she was ready."

9. Write a short two-line conversation between two characters about losing a football match, punctuating it correctly.

10. Which version of this sentence uses the colon and semicolon correctly? A) The explorer had one goal to reach the summit however the weather had other plans. B) The explorer had one goal: to reach the summit; however, the weather had other plans. C) The explorer had one goal, to reach the summit, however the weather had other plans. D) The explorer had one goal: to reach the summit, however the weather had other plans.

11. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech with a comma before the reporting clause? A) "We should leave soon" said Maya. B) "We should leave soon," said Maya. C) "We should leave soon", said Maya. D) "We should leave soon." said Maya.

12. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use semicolons to separate list items that already contain commas? A) The winners were Leo, who ran fast; Priya, who jumped high; and Sam, who threw far. B) The winners were Leo who ran fast, Priya who jumped high, and Sam who threw far. C) She packed a tent; a stove; and a torch; she was ready. D) The teams were Leeds, captained by Ana; York, captained by Ben; and Hull, captained by Cho. E) The winners were: Leo, Priya and Sam.

13. Read: "Its ready she announced holding up the cake." Which is the correctly punctuated version? A) "It's ready!" she announced, holding up the cake. B) Its ready she announced, holding up the cake. C) "Its ready" she announced holding up the cake! D) "It's ready," she announced holding up the cake!

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14. Which mark correctly joins these two closely related sentences? "The team trained hard ___ their effort paid off in the final." A) , B) ; C) : D) !

15. Explain, using one example of each, the difference in job between a colon and a semicolon.

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